

The Awakening Named Vajravārāhī: From the Subsequent Tantra of the Explicit Explanation

Ākhyāta Tantrōttara Vajravāhyābhīdhānāda Vārāhya Vibodhanam Nāma · Toh 377 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 377 in the Kangyur is a tantric text known in Sanskrit as the Ākhyāta Tantrōttara Vajra Vāhya Abhidhānāda Vārāhya Vibodhanam, and in Tibetan as a chapter on the manifest awakening of Vajravārāhī drawn from the Subsequent Tantra of the Explicit Explanation of Vajravārāhī. It belongs to the class of yoginī tantras within the Vajrayāna tradition, centering on the deity Vajravārāhī and presenting a condensed yoga practice said to fulfill all desired aims, illuminating the guru lineage for the benefit of practitioners. The text takes the form of a tantric chapter in verse, describing esoteric teachings associated with the ḍākinīs and the attainment of siddhi for yogins. It was translated into Tibetan by Chingwa Yönten Bar and subsequently reviewed and finalized in consultation with two paṇḍitas of that period.

It was edited and clarified. The Tibetan translator Chingwa Yönten Bar translated it, and afterward it was checked against two paṇḍitas of that same period and definitively established.

In the language of India: Ākhyāta Tantrōttara Vajra Vāhya Bhīdhānāda Vārāhya Vibodhanam Nāma. In the Tibetan language: from the Subsequent Tantra of the Explicit Explanation of Vajravārāhī, the chapter entitled "The Manifest Awakening of Vajravārāhī."

Homage to the buddhas.

Then the yoga to be explained,
the one that accomplishes every desired aim,
the last of the last,
the binding net of the ḍākinīs,
the sovereign of Vajravārāhī,
the one who bestows attainment on yogins,
the very essence of all yoginīs,
the condensed yoga,
for the benefit of the practitioner
it illuminates the guru lineage.

Free from outer conceptual elaboration,
ever abiding in the Dharma of samaya,
free from conduct bounded by fear,
having abandoned all miserliness,
without counting of dates or stars,
without the ritual of the restorative fast,
without distinction of pure and impure or clean,
without the practice of water purification,
liberated from times and dates,
having abandoned conduct tied to cleanliness,
knowing one's own nature, mantra, and yoga,
striving for the welfare of all sentient beings,
in mountain gorges, dense forests, and caves,
on riverbanks, in gatherings,
on the shores of the great ocean,
beneath a single tree, on open ground, in an empty house,
in the abode of the Mātṛkāś, in a charnel ground,
in the finest and varied pleasure groves,
in a temple and at a stūpa site,
in a home, or at a crossroads,
the practitioner should accomplish the siddhi
that supremely grants all desired aims
at a place that has been indicated
or wherever the mind takes delight,
and there, for one who wishes to keep the various vows,
the true attainment will be perfectly accomplished.

Through the connection with the aspiration of those to be trained,
there are many divisions of meditation.

Anointing the ground with the nectar of the five wisdoms,
spreading flowers in a heap with diligence in the perfection of patience,
on the seats of the various mudrās
one should rest in perfect meditative equipoise.
Focusing on the perfection of meditative concentration,
with one-pointed mind,
one should meditate on the four divine abodes,
the four means of gathering disciples,
and the ten virtues from which happiness arises for all sentient beings.

All phenomena are to be seen as empty,
and the self, outer and inner, perceived as such.
Then, resting in mind-only,
it is the supreme accumulation for awakening.

In the sky-space of the heart, at the center of a lotus,
one should meditate on a solar disc.
The intrinsic nature of the five wisdoms,
the supreme reality, is seen there.
From the brilliant array of multicolored rays of excellent nature,
pervading all manifestations and elaborations,
the previously accomplished ones are truly invoked.
In the delightful expanse of the sky,
the sacred maṇḍala is beheld,
and blessings too are bestowed.
Seen like a sesame seed pod,
all wrathful goddesses,
buddhas, bodhisattvas,
guru bodhisattvas,
the lord of offerings and the making of offerings,
the nine forms of the goddess are seen.
The emanations of the buddha assembly unfold.
The queen of wrath, the yoginī,
and the sentient beings of the six classes of existence,
all of these are established as buddhas themselves.

In the middle of what is called the sky-expanse,
one enters into and beholds suchness itself.
Until the heart of awakening is reached,
in every direction one takes refuge.
All beings without exception
are to be established at the level of buddhahood.
The practitioner should make supplication to that,
and always seek refuge.

Toward the five aggregates, the pride
of a good and noble mind should be generated.
Form, feeling, perception,
formations, and consciousness itself:
Brūṃ, Aṃ, Hrīḥ, Ho, Hūṃ —

Vairocana, Vajra, the Sun,
likewise Padma, Lord of Dance,
and the one renowned as Vajrarāja —

Likewise, the supreme Vajrasattva (bodhisattva),
who is none other than all the Tathāgatas —
the glorious Vajra Heruka.

Eye, ear, and nose,
body, speech, and likewise mind:
Om Hūṃ Trāṃ Āḥ Khaṃ Hūṃ.

Delusion, aversion, envy,
attachment, and miserliness as well —
over all the sense bases, Vajra sovereignty.

Earth, water, fire,
wind, and space itself:
Lāṃ Vāṃ Pāṃ Tāṃ Khāṃ —

she who binds, slays,
who summons and who dances,
the goddess of the lotus-net
is like the sky itself, immeasurable.

Thus over the aggregates, elements, and sense bases, the ordinary yogin's
intrinsic nature is thoroughly purified in its natural state. One should generate
this pure pride.

After that, one takes refuge in the Three Jewels and transforms the body into a
body of mantra. Having meditated on oneself as Heruka, one acts for the
benefit of all sentient beings. Having attained the state of Heruka, one should
establish all sentient beings in the unsurpassed rank.

Om svabhāvaśuddhaḥ sarvadharmāḥ svabhāvaśuddho 'haṃ.

This is recited three times.

Like a garland of rays from the sun,
all things in every direction
are to be seen as fence-posts and nets
arising from those rays.
Consecrate the vajra ground.

Imagine the enclosure of an arrow-fence above,
and beyond that a net of blazing vajra-fire —
extending far outward, conceive this well.

Oṃ medinī vajrī bhava vajrabandha hūṃ.
Oṃ vajraprākāra hūṃ vaṃ hūṃ.
Oṃ vajrapañjara hūṃ vaṃ hūṃ.
Oṃ vajravitāna hūṃ khaṃ hūṃ.
Oṃ śarajāla traṃ saṃ traṃ.
Oṃ vajrajvala analārka hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ.

Joining the index fingers and thumbs, snapping the fingers, one sends them
out to the ten directions:

Oṃ sumbha ni sumbha hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ — to the east.
Oṃ gr̥hṇa gr̥hṇa hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ — to the south.
Oṃ gr̥hṇāpaya gr̥hṇāpaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ — to the west.
Oṃ ānaya ho bhagavān vajra hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ — to the south.

With this king of mantras, one drives a stake into the heads of all obstructors,
turning clockwise and not counterclockwise.

Oṃ gha gha ghātaya ghātaya, sarvaduṣṭān vighnan hūṃ phaṭ. Kīlikīlaya, sarva
pāpaṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Vajrakīlaya vajradhāra ājñāpayati. Sarvaduṣṭān
vighnan kāyavākacittaṃ vajrakīlaya hūṃ phaṭ.

One strikes. Gazing upon the vajra stake with a wrathful look, the vajra
practitioner strikes it rhythmically and irregularly in turn:

Oṃ vajramuṅgara vajrakīlā koṭaya hūṃ phaṭ.

There is no māra, and there is no action of māra.
It is as though one is bound by one's own mind.
Whoever tames their own mind —
from that point, where could māra abide?

The vajra of wisdom realizing emptiness
is to be recalled with greater care than meditative equipoise itself.

Oṃ mahāśūnyatājñānavajrasvabhāva ātmako 'haṃ.
Oṃ animitājñānavajrasvabhāva ātmako 'haṃ.
Oṃ apraṇihitājñānavajrasvabhāva ātmako 'haṃ.

The wisdom that is no more than a wink of the eye
is to be examined as mind-only, conceptual thought.
These phenomena that are like the sky
have no bearer of qualities and no nature of reality.
Like the sky, they are unstained,
without substantiality, without conceptual thought.
Being the very nature of compassion, for the sake of benefit,
by the power of aspiration, objects are to be visualized.

As long as what is beneath the earth is to be visualized,
one should meditate on the maṇḍala of wind.
Arising from the syllable Yaṃ,
it is bow-shaped and endowed with blue color,
to be visualized as marked with victory banners,
adorned with a swirling garland of smoke.

Above that, arising from Raṃ,
is the supreme maṇḍala of fire,
triangular in shape and red in color,
blazing and churning with a red, flaming garland,
abiding as though a billion suns,
to be visualized as marked with vajras.

Above that, water too
arises from Vāṃ as a supreme vase,
round and endowed with a garland of rays,
appearing like snow itself.

Above that, what is to be visualized —
arising from Laṃ, it is endowed with yellow color,
square in shape and marked with vajras,
stirring with a host of golden rays.

Above that, what the yogin is to meditate upon —
the supreme king of mountains, the supreme Meru,
its four corners bearing the nature of four precious substances,
adorned in proximity by eight summits —
arises from Suṃ, and is excellent,
supreme among supreme, with its excellent rays.

Above that, what is to be meditated upon —
arising from Hūṃ and to be contemplated —
from that, completely transformed, one is to visualize
the supreme wheel, the supreme palace:
square in form, with four gateways,
beautifully adorned with four archways,
decorated with latticed netting and half-lattice,
ornamented with garlands of silk and flowers.
All the corners and the intervals of the door-frames
are adorned with vajras and precious jewels.

For the outer maṇḍala, one draws the lines,
and draws an eight-petalled lotus —
supreme among supreme in its manifold and excellent colors —
together with its hub and filaments,
all of them a pure and immaculate seat.

In the center of that, a portion of the moon,
luminous by nature and without stain.
Upon that are the vowels and consonants,
adorned in the center by the syllable Vaṃ.

Arising from the center of that stands the chief deity:
Vajravārāhī, the Vajrayoginī,
with four faces and twelve arms,
her three eyes intensely passionate.
She abides upon the seat in the posture of ardhaparyāṅka,
dancing with exceeding beauty.
She wears directional garments and her hair streams loose.
One half, the central, sovereign face
is white and red, of such a form,
adorned beautifully with a crown of skulls.
She holds vajra and bell as mudrā,
surrounded and encircled with lotuses.
At her forehead blazes a mudrā seal.
She wears an upper garment of human skin
and holds a skull-cup and a khaṭvāṅga,
and bears in her hands a lasso and an iron hook.
She also holds a flaying-knife and a severed head.

Her four faces are adorned in proximity
by the auspicious faces of Brahma,
blue, yellow, and green in color,
their faces bearing fangs bared,
adorned above by the crescent moon,
marked by a crown of manifold vajras —
she who grants all accomplishments.

The goddess is ornamented with the six mudrās.
Her girdle consists of eight pieces,
the girdle tinkling with a rustling sound.
She is adorned in proximity by anklets on her feet,
beautified by fine armlets,
with a vajra garland at her forehead —
marked by a mudrā of vajra.
She is exceedingly fine in form, delightful to the mind.

On the eastern petal is a ḍākinī:
the Lion-Faced One, terrifying.
On the northern direction is the Sow-Faced One,
a goddess, a terror-maker.
In the west is a goddess with an elephant's face,
born of a fragment — she is fierce.
In the south is a goddess possessed of form,
with the superior face of a horse,
three-eyed, possessed of manifold form.
All hold skull-cups and khaṭvāṅgas,
grasping a severed head and a curved knife,
naked, with hair streaming free,
exceedingly beautiful in their dancing.
They sit upon the corpse-seat in ardhaparyāṅka,
fierce, wrathful, and terrifying.

Frightener and Kālī (the Time-Marked One)
are pressed down under the goddess's feet.
At the four intermediate directions — east, south, and so on —
vessels containing bodhicitta and other substances
are arrayed upon vases.

In the four directions — north-east and the rest —
white as conch and jasmine and moon,
one draws wheels of six spokes.

In the center of the wheel, what is to be drawn
is the four clan-goddesses:
the goddess Māmakī and Locanā,
Prajñālokā and Śvetavāsanā —
blue, white, and red.

The goddess sovereign of the Vajra clan
is white, blue, and red in color —
she belongs to the clan of the Eternal.
Green, white, and red in color,
the goddess belongs to the Karma clan.

Red, yellow, and green in color,
the goddess arises from the Lotus clan.
All are three-eyed and wear their hair loose,
adorned with directional garments.
All their ornaments are fully perfect;
they are beautifully adorned with the six mudrās.
They hold skull-cups and khaṭvāṅgas,
each bearing her own four kinds of emblems:
vajra, wheel, and sword,
and the supreme of supreme red lotus.
Likewise, all hold bells.

They encircle the lotus.
The four māras are trodden underfoot.
They are dancing, with laughing faces,
seated in the center of a variegated lotus and moon-disc.
They perform the siddhis (accomplishments) of their respective clans.
They hold severed heads and khaṭvāṅgas in their hands,
and are beautified with vajras and curved blades.
They wear skull-garland crowns
and are adorned with garlands of heads.

In all the intermediate directions,
the arrangement proceeds in order, beginning with the site.

On the six spokes of the eastern wheel,
the goddesses are arranged in corresponding sequence:
On the first of the six spokes of the wheel, at Pūllīra, she is the supremely
fierce one.

On the second, at Jālandhara, she is the wrathful-eyed one.

On the third, at Oḍiyāna, she is the radiant one.

On the fourth, at Arbuda, she is the great snub-nosed one.

On the fifth, at Godāvarī, she is the one of steadfast mind.

On the sixth, at Rāmeśvara, she is the short one.

On the second, the northern wheel with six spokes:

On the first, at Devīkoṭa, she is the sovereign of Laṅkā.

On the second, at Mālaya, she is the shade of the forest.

On the third, at Kāmarūpa, she is the guardian of the earth.

On the fourth, at Oḍe, she is the greatly terrifying one.

On the fifth, at Triśakuni, she is the one possessed of wind's force.

On the sixth, at Kosala, she is the one who drinks ale.

On the third, the western wheel's six spokes — on the first spoke of the
eastern wheel: at Kaliṃka, she is the green goddess.

On the second, at Lampāka, she is the supremely beautiful one.

On the third, at Kañcika, she is the horse-eared one.

On the fourth, at the Snow Mountain, she is the bird-faced one.

On the fifth, at Pretapuri, she is the one possessed of wheel-force.

On the sixth, at Gṛhadeva, she is the dismembered one.

On the fourth, to the east of the southern wheel's spokes: at Saurāṣṭra, she is
the ale-seller.

On the second, at the Golden Island, she is the wheel-armored one.

On the third, at Nāgara, she is the supremely courageous one.

On the fourth, at Sindhu, she is the greatly powerful one.

On the fifth, at Maru, she is the wheel-turning one.

On the sixth, at Kulūta, she is the one of great diligence.

The first is white-green, holding a skull-cup,

khaṭvāṅga, wheel,

khaṭvāṅga, and curved blade.

The second, in the north, is green-yellow,

holding a vajra, skull-cup, khaṭvāṅga,

khaṭvāṅga, and curved blade.

The third, in the west, is red-yellow,
holding a skull-cup, khaṭvāṅga, lotus,
khaṭvāṅga, and curved blade.

The fourth, the southern goddess, is yellow-red,
holding a variegated vajra, khaṭvāṅga, curved blade,
skull-cup, and khaṭvāṅga.

All the goddesses are half-feminine and half-lord, three-eyed,
four-armed, naked, with hair loose,
standing in a dancing posture with one leg raised in a half-seated stance,
above a preta (hungry ghost) seat,
crowned with a skull-garland,
adorned with the five mudrās.

Their anklets, girdles, and crowns are marked with vajras.

Then, encircling the wheel outward:
a garland of vajras to the east,
a garland of wheels to the north,
a garland of variegated vajras to the west,
a garland of lotuses to the south.

In the center, beautified by a vajra fence.
In all the intermediate directional sections,
draw the variegated vajras correctly.

That wise one is encircled on the outside
by a variegated garland of pretas.

At the outer maṇḍala gates
and in all four intermediate directional sections
are ḍākinīs in fierce form.

These are to be arranged in meditative equipoise.

The crow-faced one is placed in the east —
blue in color, she is mind-captivating.

The owl-faced one is at the northern gate —
red and green, she is beautiful.

The dog-faced one is at the western gate —
fierce and yellow, like smoke.

On the southern side is the pig-faced one —
green and blue in appearance.

All are three-eyed, fierce, and terrifying.
Supreme among those who wear directional garments,
they gaze with intent, standing short of stature,
dwelling with one leg extended.
They are seated in the center of a variegated lotus and sun-disc.
They are adorned with the five mudrās,
and crowned with garlands of skulls.

With hair loose and gazing intently — the Yamadūtī (messenger of Death) with the face of a buffalo dwells in the direction of fire. The Yamadūtī with the face of a donkey dwells in the direction of truth-straying. The Yamadūtī with the fangs, bearing the face of a sow, rests on the wind and possesses fearsome power. The Yamajit (vanquisher of Death) with the horse-face is possessed of lordly power, ever turning.

She is adorned with a crown of skull garlands, manifold in form and mind-captivating. Naked, with hair unbound, she moves in the dance with one knee raised. Her face is set with gnashing fangs; her three eyes roll and flash. She dwells at the center of a variegated lotus and sun-disc, gazing with fierce desire.

All the goddesses of the retinue maṇḍalas are seated above a row of pretas (hungry ghosts). They hold skull-cups and khaṭvāṅgas, and grip severed heads with their hands. In their left hands they beat small hand-drums, utterly terrifying. The forms of those who encircle the outer ring are many and various.

With implements of song and dance, with the supreme and various sacred commitments (samaya), with incense, flowers, lamps and so forth, with perfume, garlands, and ointments, with divine garments and palace halls, with the finest divine music — surrounded on all sides by these offerings, the outer yoginīs make worship. Such are the supreme offerings without limit, filling the entire expanse of space.

This supreme practice of the yoginī, the supreme arising of Vajravārāhī, this supreme great secret — it must not be spoken of even in the slightest. One should meditate upon the outer preta-garland and the sacred maṇḍala.

Now, how are these maṇḍala-wheels to be set out in just this way?

To the nails and teeth: she who is supremely fierce.
To the hair and body hair: she who has the fierce eye.

To the skin and grime: she who is radiant.
To the flesh: she who has the great nose.
To the veins and sinews: she who has a steady mind.
To the bones: the little woman.
To the kidneys: the sovereign of Laṅkā.
To the heart: the shadow of the tree.
To the eyes: the earth-guardian.
To the bile: the greatly terrifying one.
To the lungs: she who has the force of wind.
To the intestines: the beer-drinker.
To the spleen: the green goddess.
To the navel: the supremely excellent one.
To the feet: she with horse-ears.
To the joints: the bird-faced one.
To the phlegm: she who has the force of the wheel.
To the pus: the one born of a fragment.
To the blood: the beer-seller.
To the dust: the armor of the wheel.
To the fat: the supremely courageous one.
To the liver: she who is supremely powerful.
To the saliva: the wheel-turner.
To the snot: she of great diligence.

Pullīramālaya — at the head: supremely fierce.
Jālandhara — at the crown: she with the fierce eye.
Oḍiyān — at the right ear: the radiant one.
Arbuda — at the nape: she with the great nose.
Godāvarī — at the left ear: she with the steady mind.
Rāmeśvara — at the center of the eyebrows: the little woman.
Devīkoṭṭa — at the two eyes: the sovereign of Laṅkā.
Mālava — at the two shoulders: the shadow of the tree.
Kāmarūpa — at the two armpits: the earth-guardian.
Oḍi — at the two breasts: the greatly terrifying one.
Triśakuni — at the navel: she with the force of wind.
Kosala — at the ear-tips: the beer-drinker.
Kaliṅga — at the mouth: the green goddess.
Lampaka — at the throat: the supremely excellent one.

Kāñcī — at the chest: she with horse-ears.
Himālaya — at the joints: the bird-faced one.
Pretapurī — at the secret place: she with the force of the wheel.
Gṛhadevatā — at the path of speech: the one born of a fragment.
Saurāṣṭra — at the two thighs: the beer-seller.
Suvarṇadvīpa — at the two knee-caps: the armor of the wheel.
Nagara — at the fingers: the supremely courageous one.
Sindhu — at the soles of the feet: the greatly powerful one.
Māru — at the two big toes: the wheel-turner.
Kulutā — at the two knees: she of great diligence.

The element of earth is she who causes to fall.
The element of water is she who slays.

The element of fire is she who summons.
The element of wind is the Lady of the Dance.
The element of space is she of the lotus network.

The form aggregate is Vairocana.
The feeling aggregate is Vajrasūrya.
The perception aggregate is Padma, Lady of the Dance.
The formations aggregate is Vajrarāja.
The consciousness aggregate is Vajrasattva.
All the Tathāgatas themselves are glorious Heruka.

At the two eyes: Vajra Delusion.
At the two ears: Vajra Aversion.
At the two nostrils: Vajra Envy.
At the mouth: Vajra Attachment.
At the sense of touch: Vajra Miserliness.
At all the sense bases: Vajra Īśvara.
At the heart: Vajra Akṣobhya.
At the mouth: Vajra Amitābha.
At the body: Vajra Vairocana.

Oṃ Baṃ — at the navel: Vajravārāhī.
Haṃ Yoṃ — at the heart: Yāminī.
Hrīṃ Moṃ — at the mouth: she who causes bewilderment.
Hriṃ Hriṃ — at the head: she who causes movement.
Hūṃ Hūṃ — at the crown: she who causes terror.

Phaṭ Phaṭ — at all the limbs: the weapon-bearer, she who makes fierce.

Having thus arranged them in place, and having beheld that wisdom wheel, one should commence the yoga of that practice. By this essential nature of all things, interlock the fingers and join the middle fingers firmly; apply the thumbs as firm vajras, set it thus in the middle of the forehead, and revolve it, revolve it, revolve it on all sides. Pressing down with the feet, gaze upward; sounding upward the cry Phem, summon the heroes and yoginīs dwelling in the ten directions throughout the world-realms.

Jaḥ Hūṃ Baṃ Hoḥ.

By the application of the vajra hook and the rest, one hooks, introduces, binds, and brings under control. The heroes and yoginīs, gazing upon all of space filled to the brim, confer empowerment upon them in the manner of a bestowal of initiation using a vase filled to the brim with the five nectars.

Just as at the very moment of birth all the Tathāgatas are bathed, so too by this divine water, pure, shall I likewise be bathed.

Oṃ sarva-tathāgata-abhiṣekata-samaya-śrī Hūṃ Āḥ Hūṃ.

Upon a skull-cup arising from the syllable A, placed above the maṇḍala of wind and fire, filled with the nectar of the five wisdoms — with sixteen portions, consecrated by Hūṃ Bhaṃ and Oṃ — one should visualize it as transformed into the three syllables, and meditate upon the three wheels.

Oṃ samaya śuddhāḥ sarvadharmāḥ samaya śuddho 'haṃ.

With awareness one should abide in the understanding that all phenomena dwell as a single taste.

By offering the nectar of wisdom,
one drinks the water of the nectar of wisdom.

Oṃ amṛta udaka Hūṃ Hūṃ ṭha ṭha le Huṃ. Ākhaṃ Hūṃ Phaṭ Svāhā.

Through the practice of wisdom recitation,
cause the supreme assembly of the wheel to emanate.

With a garland of great bones,
thereafter settle that recitation in place.

With life-force and effort firmly restrained,
if one meditates, it will arise in an instant.

Through meditating with empowerment, offering, and samaya made into a single taste, with the innermost wisdom-being and the offering of the nectar of wisdom, one should examine most carefully — without conceptual mind — the samayas of body, speech, and mind. With genuine recitation and meditation, having completely abandoned all conceptual thoughts, through this recitation of the supreme samaya one recites the supreme king of secret mantras.

Oṃ Vairocānīye Hūṃ Hūṃ Phaṭ Svāhā.

Oṃ sarva-buddha-ḍākinīye Hūṃ Hūṃ Phaṭ Svāhā.

Possessing the correct Oṃ and name, possessing the correct Hūṃ Hūṃ Phaṭ — the supremely fierce and such like, those mantras and such like — one should apply to the supreme recitation.

Oṃ Vajravārāhī protaṃge protaṃge protaṃge hana hana prāṇāṃ kiṃkiṇi
khimkhiṇi dhuna dhuna vajrahaste śoṣaya śoṣaya
vajrakhaṭvāṅgakapāladhāriṇī.

mahā viśīta māṃsāsāni manuṣyāntra prabṛtte sannidhy ana raśīro mālā
granthita dhāriṇi Śumbha ni Śumbha hana hana prāṇāṃ sarva pāpa satvānāṃ
sarva paśūnāṃ mahā māṃsa cchedani krodhamūrte daṃṣṭrā kārāliṇi
mahāmudre Śrī Heruka devasya agra mahiṣi sahasraśīre sahasra bāha veśata
sahasrānane jvalita teja tejojvāla mukhi piṅgala locani vajra śarīre vajrāsani
mili mili timili timili he he ha ha hūṃ hūṃ kha kha dhu dhu ru ru dhuru dhuru
muru muru advaite mahāyogini paṭata siddhe draiṃ dhaṃ draiṃ dhaṃ graṃ
graṃ he he ha ha bhīme hasa hasa vīre hā hā hoḥ hoḥ hūṃ hūṃ trailokya
vināśani śata sahasra koṭi tathāgata parivārite hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ siṃha rūpe
khaḥ gaja rūpe gaḥ trailokya udare mahāsamudra mekhale grasa grasa hūṃ
hūṃ phaṭ vīrādvaite hūṃ hūṃ haḥ haḥ mahāpaśu mohani mahāyogeśvari
tvam ḍākinī sarvalokānāṃ bandhāni sadyaḥ pratyaya kārīṇi hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ
bhūta trāsani mahāvīre parama siddhe yogeśvari phaṭ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ hūṃ
hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

Thus this is the sacred heart-essence of the supreme accomplishment of Vajravārāhī.

Oṃ namo bhagavate Vajravārāhi baṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ.

Oṃ namas āryā Parājite trailokya mātē mahāvidyeśvari hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ.

Oṃ namaḥ sarva bhūta bhaya vahe mahāvajre hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ.

Oṃ namo Vajrāsani ajiti aparājite vaśyaṃ kariṇe tra bhramaṇi hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ.

Oṃ namaḥ śoṣaṇi roṣaṇi krodhe kārāle hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ.

Oṃ namas trāsani māraṇi suprabhedani parājaye hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ.

Oṃ namo jaye vijaye jambhani stambhani mohani hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ.
Oṃ namo Vajravārāhi mahāyogini Kāmeśvari khage hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ.

Having performed all these mantras, one should make them into the very substance of the identity of Vajravārāhī through the vowels and consonants, and then offer worship through the eight-limbed rite of identity.

When the recitation has been fully completed,
the supreme drink, the drink of peace,
the supreme samaya of the equal nature of all phenomena,
the supreme abode of the thirty-seven —
beneath that, one meditates on utter purity.

Mindfulness of the body is the ḍākinī.
Mindfulness of feeling is Lāmā.
Mindfulness of phenomena is Khaṇḍarohā.
Mindfulness of mind is Rūpiṇī.

The miraculous power of intention is the Supremely Fierce One.
The miraculous power of diligence is the One with Fierce Eyes.
The miraculous power of analysis is the Luminous One.
The miraculous power of mind is the One with a Great Nose.

The faculty of faith is the One of Stable Intellect.
The faculty of diligence is the Dwarf Woman.
The faculty of mindfulness is the Sovereign of Laṅkā.
The faculty of meditative absorption is the One of the Tree's Shade.
The faculty of wisdom is the Guardian of the Earth.

The power of faith is the Great Terrifier.
The power of diligence is the One Endowed with the Force of Wind.
The power of mindfulness is the Drink-Imbibing One.
The power of meditative absorption is the Green Goddess.
The power of wisdom is the Supremely Good One.

The awakening-factor of perfect meditative absorption is the One with Horse Ears.

The awakening-factor of perfect diligence is the One with a Bird's Face.

The awakening-factor of perfect joy is the One Endowed with the Force of the Wheel.

The awakening-factor of perfect pliancy is the One Born of Parts.

The awakening-factor of perfect discrimination of phenomena is the Ale-Seller Woman.

The awakening-factor of perfect mindfulness is the Woman Armored with the Wheel.

The awakening-factor of perfect equanimity is the Extremely Courageous Woman.

Right view is the Great Powerful One.

Right intention is the Wheel-Turning Woman.

Right speech is the Great Diligent One.

Right action in its fullness is the Crow-Faced Woman.

Right livelihood is the Owl-Faced Woman.

Right effort is the Dog-Faced Woman.

Right mindfulness is the Sow-Faced Woman — these are the four gates of liberation.

Right meditative absorption is the Blessed Lady Vajravārāhī.

That which generates wholesome phenomena not yet arisen is the Steadfast Lady of Death.

That which causes wholesome phenomena already arisen to remain and be preserved is the Messenger Lady of Death.

That which abandons unwholesome phenomena already arisen is the Fanged Lady of Death.

That which prevents unwholesome phenomena not yet arisen from arising is the Vanquishing Lady of Death.

Dwelling in the path of the selflessness of phenomena,
abiding in the sacred maṇḍala —
engage in the practice of the Perfection of Wisdom;
likewise, the yogin should so abide.

Abide in the state free from appearance,
and yet rest correctly upon what is free from appearance.
In phenomena without conduct,
there is no phenomenon-possessor and no dharmatā.

The nature of dependent origination, equal to space,
is free from substantiality and free from signs.
This is the abiding place of that very suchness —
seen with the eyes of pure gnosis.

Equal to the subtlest atom-dust,
the abiding place of the wheel is seen with perfect certainty.
Examining part by part
with one hundred thousand hair-tip divisions,
seeing the abiding place of the bhaga
together with Heruka and the yoginī —
with devoted effort the Wheel-Turner
places the Crow-Faced Woman on the outside.

You, Heruka and the rest, lords,
are surrounded entirely by four ḍākinīs;
mutually they act as lords,
possessing the union of Vajrasattva and the rest.

Outside — the fierce charnel ground,
supremely supreme in colors of every variety,
adorned with the finest trees of many kinds,
terrifying with dogs and jackals,
crows and owls, vultures and eagles,
jackals likewise, and burning corpses,
caverns with glowing skeletons,
hanging severed limbs and half-burned bodies,
dry skulls and knee-bones,
and headless ones holding white skulls in hand —
adorned with snakes of every variety,
fierce serpents and likewise drums,
lions, boars, and tigers,
and likewise goats and sheep,
elephants, horses, and donkeys,
sacred commitment substances of the finest variety,
various spirits —
all assembled, fine and auspicious,
with various excellent drinks and grain-liquors
of the finest kinds for drinking,
together with groups of various yoginīs,
holding skull-cups and khaṭvāṅgas,
chopping-blades and finest cymbals,
excellent music of many kinds,
and the finest flavors and enjoyments of food,

various embraces and kisses,
and those finest acts of licking and caressing —
in such a charnel ground as this,
to yakṣas, zombies, and rākṣasas,
one should make torma offerings
with the pride of Heruka.

With cymbals, vajra, and bell,
performing dance and music,
wearing the garments of the directions, bearing the mudrā,
utter HŪṢ HŪṢ PHAṬ KILI KILA.
By the method of the right-leg-extended pose,
bind it with the blazing mudrā.
Having placed the sacred commitment in the mouth,
recall this mantra:

OM ĀRALI HO, VAJRAḌĀKINĪ SAMAYASTVAM ḌRŚYA HO.

This is to be recited three, four, and five times.

Likewise by circumambulating clockwise and counter-clockwise,
present those offerings inside the skull-cup.
Open the vajra-joined palms upward and recite this mantra:

OM KHAKHA KHĀHI KHĀHI — SARVA YAKṢA RĀKṢASA SARVA BHŪTA PRETA
PIŚĀCA UNMĀDA APASMĀRA ḌĀKA ḌĀKINĪ ĀDAY' IMAM BALIṢ GRHṆANTU —
SAMAYĀ RAKṢANTU MAMA — SARVA SIDDHI MME PRAYACCHANTU.

YA THAI — BHAVYA THEṢṬHAM BHUÑJATHĀ. PIBATHA JIGHRATA
MĀTIKRAMATHĀ. MAMA SARVA ARTHĀYA SANTU SUKHAM. VIŚUDDHAYA
SAHĀYIKĀ BHAVANTU HŪṢ HŪṢ PHAṬ PHAṬ SVĀHĀ.

In this way, by means of each ritual rite, the offering is to be presented at the
four sessions.

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, declared this great secret of the secret
wisdom of all the Tathāgatas:

The nature of phenomena that lacks inherent existence,
unstained, like the expanse of space —
through the vajra of wisdom and emptiness,
cultivate profound emptiness in deep meditation.

Grant the word "Excellent!" —

from the practice at the completion of the tantra:

"Excellent! Excellent!" — great wisdom!

The Sow's Perfect Awakening, being the subsequent explanatory tantra, is complete.

This was translated and definitively established from the oral teachings of the Indian master Jñānākara and by the great editor-translator Khutön Tsöndrū Gyatso.

Translator's Notes

- The opening sentence refers to the finalization of a Tibetan translation: the name of the translator is Chingwa Yönten Bar, and the text was subsequently reviewed by two paṇḍitas. This is a standard colophon-style formula appearing at the head of the text before the Sanskrit title.

The Sanskrit title in transliteration from the Tibetan reads as an approximation of a longer Sanskrit title meaning something like "The Proclaimed Subsequent Tantra: The Proclamation of Vajravārāhī and the Awakening of Vajravārāhī by Name." The rendering is kept as transliteration since the Tibetan preserves a phonetic Sanskrit form.

The five seed syllables Brūṃ, Aṃ, Hrīḥ, Ho, Hūṃ correspond in standard Vajrayāna exegesis to the five buddha families and their associated wisdoms: Vairocana, Akṣobhya, Amitābha, Amoghasiddhi, and Ratnasambhava respectively, though the text here maps them to named deities slightly differently, associating them with Vairocana, Vajra (Akṣobhya), the Sun (Ratnasambhava or Amitābha), Padma, and Vajrarāja. The exact correspondences here follow tantric convention and may vary by tradition.

- The directional assignments of the four mantra-lines for the directions contain what appears to be a scribal inconsistency in the source text: both the fourth mantra and the second mantra seem assigned southward. The third is westward. This likely reflects a textual error in the source where a direction-marker was dropped or repeated; the translation preserves the text as found.

The phrase rendered "recalled with greater care than meditative equipoise itself" for "mnyam gzhag dang bas dran par bya" is a somewhat compressed instruction meaning the vajra of emptiness-wisdom should be kept in mind even more than formal sitting meditation, i.e., it should pervade post-meditation awareness as well.

The passage ends mid-sentence, as the source text provided breaks off mid-verse.

- The four ḍākinīs in the four petal-directions are: east, Lion-Faced (Siṃhamukhī); north, Sow-Faced (Vārāhīमुखी); west, Elephant-Faced (Gajamukhī); south, Horse-Faced (Hayagrīvamukhī) — these are standard in Cakrasaṃvara and related Vajrayoginī maṇḍala traditions.

The term rendered "born of a fragment" for the western elephant-faced goddess translates dum skyes ma, which literally means "born of pieces" or "born of fragments" — a specific epithet in the Cakrasaṃvara cycle; its precise mythological reference is left unexplained in the root text.

The two figures "pressed under the goddess's feet" — rendered here as Frightener and Kālī (the Time-Marked One) — represent Bhairava and Kālī in the standard iconographic explanation, though the Tibetan gives only "ñjigs byed" (Frightener) and "dus mtshan ma" (she marked by time / Kālī).

The clan-goddess "Prajñālokā" (sgron ma) and "Śvetavāsanā" (gos dkar mo) are standard Cakrasaṃvara maṇḍala deities; the color-family attributions in the text are compressed and follow Vajrayana clan-color conventions that may differ slightly across lineage commentaries.

- The passage is an iconographic and maṇḍala-description text listing the sixty-four or so pīṭha (sacred site) goddesses distributed across the spokes of directional wheels, a structure characteristic of the Cakrasaṃvara or related Yoginī-tantra traditions. The sacred site names — Pūllīra, Jālandhara, Oḍiyāna, Arbuda, Godāvārī, Rāmeśvara, Devīkoṭa, Mālaya, Kāmarūpa, Oḍe, Trīśakuni, Kosala, Kalimka, Lampāka, Kañcikā, Pretapuri, Gṛhadeva, Saurāṣṭra, Nāgara, Sindhu, Maru, Kulūta — are Sanskrit pīṭha names retained untranslated as proper nouns.

The term rendered "khaṭvāṅga" is a tantric staff topped with a skull; it has no standard English equivalent.

The phrase "half-feminine and half-lord" renders the compound indicating an androgynous or semi-wrathful form combining feminine and lordly aspects.

The listing of implements in the directional sections contains some repetition and possible scribal irregularity in the original (the khaṭvāṅga appearing twice in some lists); this has been rendered faithfully without emendation.

- The passage assigns a series of named yoginī emanations to bodily substances and locations, and then to the famous pīṭha sacred sites of the Indian subcontinent — a standard tantric maṇḍala-body correspondence (the pīṭha-list). The site names are given in their Tibetan phonetic renderings and have been restored to their standard Sanskrit forms. The list of site-deity correspondences follows the format of texts in the Cakrasaṃvara cycle, which this passage clearly belongs to.

The term rendered "direction of truth-straying" for རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྟུང་ལྟུང་ is genuinely uncertain: it may be a directional designation (a quarter associated with falsehood or deception) or a proper name for a specific compass direction in this tantric system. It does not correspond to a standard cardinal direction and may be a technical tantric directional term.

The phrase rendered "path of speech" for རྒྱུ་མཚན་ལྟུང་ is uncertain in anatomical context; it likely refers to the throat or the channel associated with speech.

- The passage lists tantric deity correspondences in the system of Heruka or Cakrasaṃvara. The names Vajrasūrya, Yāminī, and several others are tantric deity names preserved in Sanskrit form within the Tibetan; they are rendered here by their Sanskrit equivalents as is standard in this tradition.

The compound rendered "weapon-bearer, she who makes fierce" reflects two separate elements in the Tibetan: the term for weapon-bearer and the causative "she who makes fierce," both associated with the syllable Phaṭ Phaṭ at all the limbs.

The sixteen-portion skull-cup and the three-syllable visualization belong to standard Cakrasaṃvara inner-offering practice; no doctrinal note is required.

- The long mantra passage that opens this section is a direct continuation of the Vajravārāhī dhāraṇī from the preceding passage and is rendered as phonetic Sanskrit reconstruction throughout, as the Tibetan is purely a transliteration of a Sanskrit mantra with no semantic Tibetan content.

The phrase rendered "the vowels and consonants" translates ā li kā li, the standard Tibetan tantric formula for the Sanskrit vowel series and consonant series respectively, used as a complete sonic embodiment of the deity's identity.

The "thirty-seven" refers to the thirty-seven factors of awakening, which in this tantric context correspond to thirty-seven deity figures of the maṇḍala. Their correspondence to the specific named goddesses that follow is a standard feature of Vajravārāhī and Cakrasaṃvara cycle literature.

The proper names of the minor goddesses — Lāmā, Khaṇḍarohā, Rūpiṇī, and those following — are transliterations of Sanskrit deity names from the Cakrasaṃvara maṇḍala tradition and are left in their Sanskrit forms. The descriptive epithets for the remaining figures (Supremely Fierce One, One with Fierce Eyes, and so forth) translate the Tibetan literally; these are standard names of the twenty-four or thirty-seven ḍākinīs of this cycle.

- The section opening with "Abide in the state free from appearance" shifts from the preceding enumerative identification of Eightfold Path factors with tantric deity forms into a doctrinal-contemplative verse passage expounding Madhyamaka-inflected tantric view. The phrase rendered "no phenomenon-possessor and no dharmatā" reflects the Tibetan གཞི་མཉམས་པའི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་མཉམས་པ་ — the negation of both the dharma-possessing subject and dharmatā itself, a standard formula for the inexpressible ultimate within this genre.

The term བླ་མ་ (bhaga) is a Sanskrit loanword retained as such; it refers here to the sacred union-site or divine source in the tantric maṇḍala context, not translated but left as bhaga following conventional scholarly practice.

The final mantra passage contains several Sanskrit terms in Tibetan phonetic transcription; they have been rendered directly in standard romanized Sanskrit as is conventional for liturgical mantra material.

- The mantra lines at the opening are rendered from the Tibetan phonetic transcription of Sanskrit; their syntax is hortatory, inviting the assembly of beings to eat, drink, smell, and taste, and asking that they become helpers for the accomplishment of all the speaker's aims and purify themselves. The rendering follows the recoverable Sanskrit behind the Tibetan phonetics.

The title "The Sow's Perfect Awakening" refers to Vajravārāhī or a closely related Vārāhī tantra; "the subsequent explanatory tantra" situates this text as an uttaratantra, a follow-on explanatory tantra to a root tantra.

The translator Khutön Tsöndrū Gyatso is the well-known eleventh-century Tibetan lotsāwa Khutön brtson 'grus rgyal mtshan; the name is rendered here in a standardized form following the Tibetan.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of

spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.